

KOLKATA | The Wrong Mix

The Mamata Banerjee juggernaut got its first jolt last week when it lost the Siliguri Corporation Board in north Bengal to what the leader termed was “gross betrayal” by the Congress state leadership with active help from the CPI(M). The CPI(M) voted en masse for the Congress candidate for mayor with the contest tied at 15 each for the Trinamool Congress and the Congress with neither party willing to give up the mayor’s seat. The alliance of the Congress and the Trinamool now finds itself in a soup with the Left taking this occasion as a sort of revival for the CPI(M) which, after the last Lok Sabha elections and subsequent Mamata wave, had nothing to look forward to. Mamata has stopped short of calling Congress chief Sonia Gandhi names. However, it is now obvious that the state Congress has Sonia’s blessings in asking for Left support to stump the Trinamool, which it feels was hardly behaving like a true



alliance partner and acting big brother all the time. At a rally in Siliguri on October 4, Banerjee ate humble pie and declared, “I am sorry. I have not been able to keep my word and the mandate of the people has been ignored by the betrayers.”

by Abhijit Dasgupta

MUMBAI | Shielding the Sniffers



The Mumbai Police is carrying out trials of bulletproof jackets for their canine colleagues, the sniffer dogs. The Level III A jackets being tested can shield a sniffer dog from carbine bullets, splin-

COMMANDOS WITH A SNIFFER DOG

ters from grenades and small bombs. Sniffer dogs had scoured Nariman House and the Taj Mahal Hotel for explosives during the 26/11 terror attacks. They also sniffed out the body of the tenth terrorist. Anjani Technoplast, a private armouring company, has the capability to make such jackets and has given a few pieces to the NSG to try. Vijay Gupta, chief adviser at Anjani Technoplast says, “Sniffer dogs are vulnerable during terror attacks as they are pushed into sniffing out bombs. These are specialised dogs that need protection.” The Mumbai Police’s defective bulletproof jackets had whipped up a political storm and public outrage following the Mumbai terror attacks.

by Nishika Patel

CHANDIGARH | Hurt, Not Out

When Rajinder Mohan Singh Chinna was appointed the chief of the Amritsar Improvement Trust three months ago, cricketer-turned-BJP MP Navjot Singh Sidhu disappeared. Sidhu was protesting Chinna’s appointment. Chinna, a rich businessman, is former secretary of the state BJP and has just been appointed the chairman of Punjab State Industrial Export

VISHAL KUMAR



SIDHU

Corporation. Sidhu’s camp claims that Chinna had worked against his party colleague in the last Lok Sabha polls in May. “Have you ever heard a cricketer score zero in both the innings of a Test and get the Man of the Match Award?” asked Sidhu. He returned to Amritsar to a hearty welcome after a three-month hiatus.

by Arvind Chhabra